ENG-0015 Incident Postmortem: INC-073

Impact

The incident designated as INC-073 affected the `auth-worker` system (System ID: SYS-004), which is a critical component managed under Project Juniper. The severity level was classified as Sev2, indicating a significant impact on system availability and performance. The disruption lasted for approximately 5.5 hours, during which authentication services experienced degraded functionality, potentially affecting user access and operational workflows. Given the high criticality of the `auth-worker` system, the incident posed a risk to ongoing project deliverables and operational stability.

Timeline

- **2025-04-10:** The incident was reported by Michele Williams, a Marketing Specialist based in Singapore, at approximately 09:00 local time. The initial detection was linked to anomalies observed in authentication processes.
- **2025-04-10:** Crystal Robinson, Project Manager for Project Juniper and on-call engineer for SYS-004, was notified and began incident response activities promptly.
- **2025-04-10:** The root cause was identified as a configuration change applied to the `auth-worker` system, which led to the service disruption.
- **2025-04-10:** Resolution efforts commenced immediately, involving rollback procedures and configuration adjustments.
- **2025-04-10:** The system was fully restored and stabilized by approximately 14:30, marking the end of the incident response.
- **2025-04-10:** The incident was officially closed, with a total resolution time of 5.5 hours.

Root Cause

The root cause of INC-073 was a configuration change implemented within the `auth-worker` system. This change was identified as the primary factor that led to the system's degraded performance and eventual service disruption. The change was executed without sufficient validation, which contributed to the failure to detect the adverse effects prior to deployment. The incident underscores the importance of rigorous change management and validation processes, especially for systems with high criticality like `auth-worker`.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Description
Implement enhanced change validation procedures for critical systems	Configuration Management Team	2025-04-15	Develop and enforce stricter validation protocols to prevent untested configuration changes from affecting production systems.

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Description
Conduct a review of recent configuration changes to identify potential gaps	Change Review Board	2025-04-12	Analyze recent changes to ensure compliance with established procedures and identify areas for process improvement.
Reinforce incident response training for on-call engineers, including Crystal Robinson	Training Department	2025-04-20	Provide targeted training to improve incident detection and response times, emphasizing communication and escalation protocols.
Schedule a post-incident review meeting with all stakeholders involved in Project Juniper	Project Lead (E-090)	2025-04-14	Facilitate a comprehensive review of the incident, lessons learned, and preventive measures.

Additional Notes

Crystal Robinson, the Project Manager and on-call engineer responsible for SYS-004 during the incident, demonstrated prompt response and effective coordination in resolving INC-073. The incident highlights the need for ongoing vigilance in change management processes and reinforces the importance of thorough testing before deploying configuration modifications to high-criticality systems such as `auth-worker`. Moving forward, the team will prioritize strengthening controls around configuration changes and incident preparedness to mitigate future risks.